



Versatile player: Nabi's red-ball record over the last couple of seasons often resulted in him being labelled a long-format expert. But one glance at his limited-overs records shows he's no dud with the white ball either. EMMANUAL YOGINI

to pitch the ball in the right area and move the ball, he should be encouraged," he opined.

Nabi's red-ball record over the last couple of seasons often resulted in him being labelled a long-format expert. But one glance at his limited-overs records shows he's no dud with the white ball either.

He has picked up 42 wickets in 29 List A matches at an average of 28.88 and 28 T20 wickets in 27 games at 26.39. "In India, people say the white ball doesn't swing. The myth spreads easily. But I have seen Nabi swing the white ball, too," bowling coach Krishna Kumar said.

Despite attending multiple trials over the last few years, Nabi has yet to find an Indian Premier League gig.

The Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy 2025 will be another step in the audition ladder ahead of the upcoming iteration of the IPL auction. Krishna Kumar says he is confident Nabi will find a taker.

"He definitely has the quality to play. He has got a fantastic yorker and can bowl six of them on the trot. And the best part is, he is very calm in his mind. He doesn't take pressure. What else do you need from a bowler?" he said.

The IPL, often considered the closest to international cricket in terms of high-quality opposition and high-pressure environments, might be the final tick in the box that India's cricketing top-brass needs to be convinced of Nabi's aptitude to play at the highest level.

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First-Class:

Matches: 36
Wickets: 125
Average: 19.98
Strike Rate: 41.2
5-wicket hauls: 12
10-wicket match hauls: 3

List-A:

Matches: 29
Wickets: 42
Average: 28.88
Strike Rate: 34.1
Economy Rate: 5.07

T20s:

Matches: 29
Wickets: 32
Average: 25.65
Strike Rate: 19.1
Economy Rate: 8.03